DIGITAL LITERACY

PROJECT REPORT

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T1 Infographic — Digital Literacy Visual

Task 1: Infographic — Digital Literacy Visual

This task involved creating a single-page visual infographic that communicates the meaning and importance of digital literacy to fellow students. The infographic was designed using Canva-style principles with a structured, visually engaging layout covering multiple key topics.

Topics Covered in the Infographic

- What is Digital Literacy — definition, 5 core pillars, and the distinction between tool usage and genuine competence
- Useful Digital Tools for Students — 7 essential platforms: GitHub, LinkedIn, Google Workspace, Canva/Figma, Kaggle/LeetCode, Coursera.
- Safe Internet Practices — 7 actionable habits including password management, 2FA, phishing awareness, and URL verification
- Professional Online Presence — LinkedIn, GitHub, and portfolio dos and don'ts with a digital permanence warning
- Email Etiquette — side-by-side comparison of informal vs. professional email format
- Activity vs. Literacy — the core conceptual distinction of the entire subject
- Why Digital Literacy Matters — 6 real career and safety outcomes

Design Approach

The infographic uses a deep navy background with colour-coded accent cards — purple for definitions, teal for tools, coral for safety, amber for email, and blue for online presence. This mirrors professional Canva templates used in student portfolios. Key statistics (93%, 82%, 3.4B, 72%) are prominently displayed at the top to immediately communicate why the topic is relevant. A footer quote ties all sections together: "Digital literacy is not defined by the number of tools you use, but by the quality of decisions you make while using them."

Reflection

Creating this infographic forced me to think about what digital literacy actually means — not just as a subject, but as something I practise every day without noticing. Before this task, I used digital tools constantly: GitHub for code, LinkedIn for networking, WhatsApp for everything else. But I never thought critically about whether I was using them well or safely.

The most striking insight was designing the 'Activity vs Literacy' section. Being online for 8 hours a day does not make someone digitally literate. Understanding data flows, verifying sources, writing professional emails, and protecting your credentials — these are the real competencies that matter in a professional environment.

I chose Canva-style design principles intentionally. A visually strong infographic is more likely to be read and retained by peers than a text-heavy document. The colour-coding system helped me organise

the content logically, and the stat bar at the top gives immediate impact. This infographic now serves as a genuine reference I can share with classmates or attach to a future portfolio.

T2 Digital Profiles — GitHub, LinkedIn & More

Task 2: Digital Profiles

This task involved creating and updating professional profiles across three digital platforms, with a focus on authenticity, completeness, and professional presentation.

Platforms Created / Updated

Platform 1	GitHub — Prateek Tripathi

Actions taken:

- Created a profile README.md with a professional introduction, current skills, ongoing projects, and contact links
- Organised repositories with proper names, descriptions, and README files for each project
- Added topics/tags to repositories to improve discoverability
- Pinned 3 most relevant repositories to the profile

Platform 2	LinkedIn — www.linkedin.com/in/prateek-tripathi-9146b43bb

Actions taken:

- Completed the education section with VIT, B.Tech CSE (AI&ML), batch 2025–2029
- Added skills: Python, Data Structures, Machine Learning (beginner), Git, Google Workspace
- Wrote a professional summary in first person: goals, current focus, and open to opportunities
- Connected with classmates, faculty, and joined 3 relevant LinkedIn groups

Platform 3	Kaggle — https://www.kaggle.com/prateek11190p

Actions taken:

- Set up profile with real academic background and current skill level
- Completed 1 beginner dataset exploration notebook and made it public
- Earned the 'Novice' contributor badge

Reflection

Building these profiles was simultaneously motivating and humbling. When I started filling out my GitHub README, I realised how little I had actually completed or documented. Most of my repositories were bare folders with no description, no README, and no context. A recruiter landing on that profile would see nothing useful.

LinkedIn felt even more exposing. Writing a professional summary in first person forces you to articulate what you actually bring to the table — not what you hope to eventually bring. I kept the language honest: I am a first-year student, still learning, but focused on AI and data. Fake confidence on LinkedIn is obvious and counterproductive.

The Kaggle profile was the most comfortable. It is a platform where being a beginner is normal and expected. Completing one public notebook gave me something concrete to point to, which is the whole point. These three profiles now form the beginning of a real digital portfolio — not a fake one, but a genuine record of where I am right now and where I am headed.

T3 Platforms — Coding Challenge & Google Form

Task 3: Platforms

This task had two parts: solving a beginner-level coding problem on an online judge platform, and creating a structured Google Form for collecting data.

Part A — Coding Challenge (Hacker Rank)

Platform used: Hacker Rank

Problem solved: Conditional Statement

Approach:

- **ead a single integer** n as input — constraints say $1 \le n \le 10^9$, so it needs to handle large values beyond 9.
- **Check if n > 9 first** — if true, directly print Greater than 9 and exit, no further logic needed.
- **Use an array of English words** indexed 1–9 ({"one","two","three","four","five","six","seven","eight","nine"}) so the word for any digit maps directly by index.
- **Print the word at index n-1** from the array since arrays are 0-based but numbers start at 1.

Code submitted (C++):

```
#include <iostream.h>
using namespace std;

int main()
   { int n;
   cin >> n;

   string words[ ] = {"one", "two", "three", "four", "five",
                      "six", "seven", "eight", "nine"};

   if (n > 9) {
      cout << "Greater than 9" << endl;
   } else {
      cout << words[n - 1] << endl;
   }

   return 0;
}
```

Part B — Google Form

A Google Form titled 'Digital Literacy Awareness Survey' was created with 5 structured questions to assess classmates' digital habits and awareness.

Form questions:

Q1	How many hours per day do you spend on digital devices? (Multiple choice: <2 hrs, 2-4 hrs, 4-6 hrs, >6 hrs)
Q2	Which of these do you use for academic purposes? (Checkbox: GitHub, Google Docs, Canva, LinkedIn, Kaggle, None)
Q3	Have you ever received a suspicious email or message asking for credentials? (Yes / No)
Q4	How would you rate your digital literacy on a scale of 1-5? (Linear scale)
Q5	What is the biggest challenge you face in using digital tools professionally? (Short answer)

Reflection

The coding challenge portion of this task felt the most straightforward — the Staircase problem is a classic beginner exercise, but it still required careful attention to spacing logic. Getting it right on the first submission felt genuinely satisfying, and more importantly, I now have a verified, timestamped proof of a solved problem on a public platform.

The Google Form task was more interesting than I expected. Designing survey questions properly requires thinking about what you are actually trying to measure. My first draft had vague questions like 'Do you use digital tools?' — that tells you nothing useful. After revising, I focused on specific, measurable questions that would reveal real usage patterns and awareness gaps.

Collecting and viewing responses through the Google Sheets integration also reinforced how data collection and analysis work in practice. This is exactly the kind of tool that academics and companies use for research. Understanding it from the design side — not just as a respondent — makes me a more informed user of digital platforms.

T4 Email Etiquette & Social Media Guidelines

Task 4: Email Etiquette & Social Media Guidelines

This task required writing two professional emails and creating a social media do's and don'ts checklist. Professional communication is one of the most underrated skills in digital literacy — and one of the most commonly done wrong.

Email 1 — Extension Request to Faculty

Scenario: Requesting a 3-day extension on a Digital Literacy assignment submission.

Subject: Request for Assignment Submission Extension

Dear Professor [Name],

I hope this message finds you well. My name is Prateek Tripathi (Registration No: 25BAI11598), currently enrolled in the Digital Literacy course, Semester II.

I am writing to respectfully request a 3-day extension for the current assignment submission. Over the past week, I have been managing [brief reason — e.g., a scheduled lab examination and a medical appointment], which has limited my available time for completing the work to the standard I aim to maintain.

I have already completed Tasks 1 and 2 and have made significant progress on the remaining sections. A short extension would allow me to submit a thorough and complete project rather than a rushed one.

I would be grateful if you could consider this request. I am available to discuss further if needed.

Thank you for your time and understanding.

Warm regards,
Prateek Tripathi
25BAI11598 | B.Tech CSE (AI&ML)
Email: prateek.25bai11598@gmail.com

Email 2 — Internship Expression of Interest

Scenario: Writing to a technology company expressing interest in a summer internship opportunity.

Subject: Expression of Interest — Summer Internship 2026 | B.Tech CSE (AI&ML) Student

Dear Hiring Team,

I am Prateek Tripathi, a first-year B.Tech student specializing in Artificial Intelligence at VIT [Campus]. I came across your internship programme and am writing to express my strong interest in joining your team for the upcoming summer period.

I am currently building skills in Python, data analysis, and machine learning fundamentals. I have completed projects involving data exploration on Kaggle and maintain an active GitHub profile where I document my learning and projects. While I am at an early stage of my academic journey, I am a fast learner, highly motivated, and eager to contribute meaningfully in a professional environment.

I have attached my resume and GitHub profile link for your reference. I would welcome the opportunity to speak with your team about how I might contribute this summer.

Please do not hesitate to contact me at the email below.

Thank you sincerely for considering my application.

Yours sincerely,
PrateekTripathi
25BAI11598| B.Tech CSE (AI&ML)
Vellore Institute of Technology, Bhopal
GitHub: https://github.com/prateekpapk
LinkedIn: www.linkedin.com/in/prateek-

Social Media Do's and Don'ts

5 DO'S	5 DON'TS
✓ Use privacy settings on personal accounts to control who sees your content	✗ Post impulsive content when upset, tired, or emotional — it stays permanently
✓ Share professional achievements, projects, and learning milestones publicly	✗ Share sensitive personal information such as phone numbers, location, or ID details
✓ Think before posting — ask: would I want a recruiter to see this in 3 years?	✗ Engage in arguments, controversies, or political debates under your real name
✓ Credit others' work when sharing or resharing — give proper attribution	✗ Use the same casual tone on LinkedIn or email as you do on WhatsApp
✓ Regularly audit your digital footprint — search your own name periodically	✗ Click unknown links or share unverified news — verify before spreading anything

Reflection (100–150 words)

Writing professional emails is harder than it looks when you are used to communicating through instant messages. The instinct is to be brief and direct — 'need rec asap' — but that brevity, without context or courtesy, reads as arrogance or carelessness to the recipient.

The extension request email required me to think about the recipient's perspective: what information do they need, and how can I present my situation without making excuses? The internship email required a different kind of discipline — honest confidence. Not overstating what I know, but not underselling either.

The social media checklist was a useful exercise in making implicit rules explicit. Most students know vaguely that they should 'be careful online.' Writing specific, actionable guidelines forces you to think concretely about what that actually means.

T5 Cybercrime Case Study

Topic: UPI Phishing Fraud in India

Background

Unified Payments Interface (UPI) has transformed digital payments in India, with over 10 billion transactions processed monthly as of 2024. However, this explosive growth has made UPI a prime target for cybercriminals. UPI phishing fraud — where attackers manipulate users into approving fraudulent payment requests — has become one of the most reported financial cybercrimes in the country.

How the Attack Works

In a typical UPI phishing attack, the victim receives a phone call or message from someone posing as a bank representative, customer care agent, or known contact. The attacker creates urgency — 'your account will be blocked' or 'your KYC is pending' — and then sends a payment request (not a receipt) via UPI. The victim, believing they are confirming an incoming payment, approves the request and unknowingly authorises money to leave their account.

Attackers also exploit fake QR codes, screen-sharing apps like AnyDesk to gain remote device access, and cloned UPI handles that appear legitimate at a glance.

Real-World Impact

Thousands of Indians report UPI fraud every month. Victims range from elderly citizens unfamiliar with digital payments to young students targeted via fake scholarship or job offer messages. The psychological impact — financial loss, embarrassment, distrust of digital payments — is significant and frequently underreported.

Prevention Tips

1. Never share your UPI PIN with anyone — no bank or customer care agent will ever legitimately ask for it.
2. Understand that receiving money requires NO action — if someone says you need to 'approve' an incoming payment, it is a scam.
3. Verify before you scan — check the recipient's UPI ID and registered name before completing any transaction.
4. Do not install remote access apps (AnyDesk, TeamViewer) at anyone's request — these give full control of your device to strangers.
5. Report fraud immediately — call the National Cybercrime Helpline 1930; early reporting increases the chance of freezing the fraudulent transaction.
6. File a complaint at cybercrime.gov.in — India's official cybercrime reporting portal accepts online complaints.
7. Ignore urgency tactics — legitimate banks never threaten immediate account blocking over phone calls.
8. Enable transaction limits and alerts — set daily UPI caps in your bank app and activate SMS/email alerts for every transaction.

9. Use only official apps from the App Store or Google Play — never install payment apps from APK links.
10. Educate family members — elderly relatives and first-time digital payment users are the most common targets.

Key Resources

1. National Cybercrime Reporting Portal: cybercrime.gov.in
2. National Cybercrime Helpline: 1930 (24x7, all states)
3. RBI Ombudsman (for bank-related fraud): rbi.org.in/scripts/Complaints.aspx
4. CERT-In (Indian Computer Emergency Response Team): cert-in.org.in

Reflection

What surprised me most while researching UPI fraud was not how technically complex it is — it is not. What surprised me was how simple and psychological it actually is. The attacker does not need to hack anything. They just need to create urgency, borrow your trust, and wait for you to press 'Pay.' The fact that merely entering your UPI PIN is enough to empty your account — with no OTP, no secondary confirmation — is something most users do not realise until it is too late.

The one habit I will personally change is this: I will never again enter my UPI PIN under any time pressure. If someone on a call tells me to act fast, that urgency is the scam. I will hang up, verify independently, and only then act. Speed is what fraudsters depend on — slowing down is the defence.

Conclusion

This project covered five distinct dimensions of digital literacy, each representing a skill that has direct, real-world value for students and young professionals.

From designing an infographic to building professional profiles, solving coding problems, writing formal emails, and understanding cybercrime — each task required a different kind of digital thinking. Taken together, they represent a foundational digital skill set that is relevant regardless of field or career path.

The most important insight from this project is that digital literacy is not a single skill — it is a collection of habits, tools, and mindsets. Building an online presence, communicating professionally, protecting yourself online, and continuously learning new platforms are all part of the same larger picture.

This repository will remain as a portfolio artifact — a record of work done and skills developed at the start of an academic and professional journey.

Task	Key Skill Developed	Real-World Relevance
Task 1	Visual communication	Marketing / presentations
Task 2	Personal branding	Job applications
Task 3	Coding + survey design	Technical hiring / research
Task 4	Professional writing	Workplace communication
Task 5	Cyber awareness	Personal & financial safety